

PORTLAND
Public Schools

Climate Crisis Response Policy

May 12, 2026 Staff Update

Context

Policy Passed March 2022

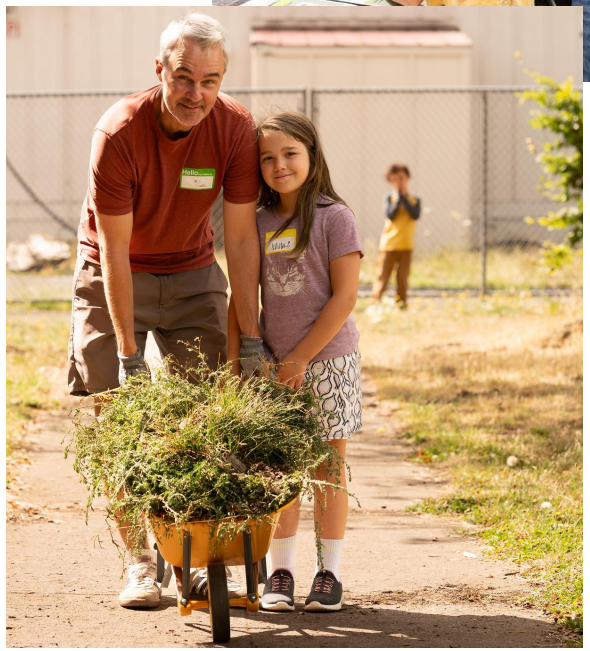
PPS Commits to swiftly mobilize resources for climate action to:

- Reducing greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions and minimizing other negative environmental impacts;
- improving our school communities' health and wellness; and
- building a culture of learning, responsibility, and sustainability centered on our values of racial equity and climate justice.
- educate and empower students as leaders in the just transition to a sustainable city and restorative society.

3 Pillars, 10 Goals, 75+ objectives

Policy Goals





Two Overarching Goals

- Reduce greenhouse gas emissions by 50 percent by 2030, net zero emissions by 2040
- Elevate engagement, resilience and wellness

Three Pillars

- Reduce Environmental Impact & Costs
- Improve Health and Wellness
- Provide Effective Environmental & Sustainability Education

Requires an annual report to the Board and the development of a community-oversight committee, the Climate Crisis Response Committee.

Decarbonization Commitment

Policy Commitments:

- **2030:** Reduce Emissions by 50% of 2018-2019 baseline
- **2040**: Reach Net Zero GHG Emissions
- **2050**: Phase out all fossil fuel infrastructure and equipment in new construction and existing buildings





Climate Crisis Response Committee

2024 - 2025 Recommendations

1. Align Climate Work with PPS Priority Goals
2. Embed Transparency and Engagement Tools
3. Preserve and Scale Climate Programs
4. Institutionalize Student Voice
5. Expand and Redesign the PPS Volunteer Program to Include Climate Policy Implementation Support

2025-2026 Priorities

- **Integrate the Decarbonization Roadmap** into district operations.
- **Integrate climate literacy** into curriculum adoptions processes.
- **Increase support systems for student action** and empowerment through the Student Climate Projects.
- **Increase accessibility and transparency** to information on climate action on Climate Justice + Sustainability website.



Lincoln HS + Ida B Wells HS 2026 Student-led Climate Justice Summit

25-26 Climate Policy Progress

Emissions Reduction

- With three fully-electric high school modernizations, PPS is **on track to reach the 2030 GHG goal.**
- District-wide **LED upgrades complete**
- **100% fully-electric leaf-blowers**

Transportation:

- **27 electric school buses** (10 district-owned buses, 17 contract-owned buses)
- **59 schools** participated in Safe Routes to Schools (SRTS) programming, engaging **76% of students in grades PK-8**





Climate Policy Progress Highlights

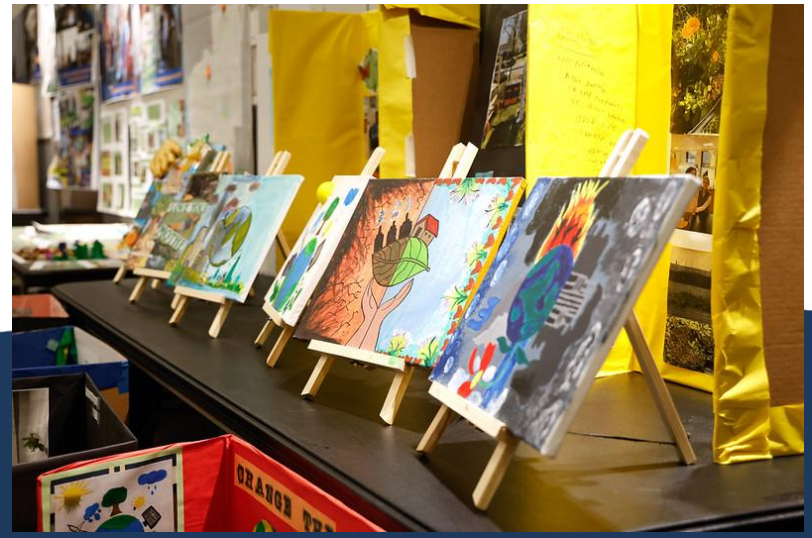
Health & Wellness

- Emergency **cooling pilot**

Climate Literacy:

- **Align Oregon Climate Literacy Standards** with curriculum adoptions.
- Expansion of **Climate Justice high school elective** to one-year, full science recovery credit





Climate Friendly Public Schools Program

25/26 Program Highlights

- **100%** of eligible schools participated
- Over **2,700 students** involved in planning and project development
- Nearly **20,000 students** anticipated to engage / participate in project activities
- **99 projects** proposed and approved!
- **$443,247** budgeted
- **47** Student Climate Project Advisors (SCPAs)
- **37+ Community Partners**



Climate Friendly Public Schools Program

Student & Community Showcase

- **20** registered schools and **over 300 students** in attendance
- **Every school** featured through exhibit submissions and project photographs
- **Student presentations** from **3 schools**, highlighting physical improvements, behavior change, and advocacy skills
- Celebration by district & PCEF leadership, including remarks from **Superintendent Armstrong** and **Board Chair Wang**



Climate Friendly Public Schools Program

25/26 Program Support

- **Communication:** Simplified structures and more consistent messaging
- **Contracting:** Clearer, more efficient contracting process
- **Role Expectations:** Clearer extended responsibility expectations
- **Advisor Supports:** Monthly group meetings and 1:1 support
- **Student Supports:** Additional adult volunteer support (grades 6–8)
- **Administrative Supports:** Budget and expense workbooks for school admin teams
- **Resource Development:** Ongoing creation and refinement of program resources informed by student and advisor feedback
- **Partnerships:** Community outreach and partner packages that connect student projects with professional expertise
- **Volunteer Support:** Advanced 24-25 CCRC Recommendation to increase capacity, Eco-School Network partnership



Moving Forward

Challenges: Limited staff capacity, resources, and strategic alignment

To Maintain Progress

- Continue to operationalize policy goals into existing district processes
- Prioritize internal and external communication, and volunteer support







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Climate Crisis Response Committee

Climate Crisis Response Committee Duties

1. To r**eceive regular reports and data** from District staff on the current status and planned implementation of the Policy goals and directives, including the impact of the policy implementation on frontline communities;

2. To determine **whether such status and implementation are consistent with the identified goals** of the Policy; and

3. To **share written** findings with the Board on at least an annual basis; the Committee may **make recommendations** to the Board as part of their work.

Climate Crisis Response Committee

2025-2026 Key Successes & Challenges

- Commitment to emissions reductions
  - Electrification in High School modernizations
  - PCEF Collaborating with Climate action grant
- Climate Friendly Public Schools program
  - Engaging over 20,000 students
- Student Climate Awareness Survey distribution

- Loss of transparency
  - Climate Policy Public Dashboard
- Significant capacity limitations
  - Staff vacancies & eliminations
  - Decarbonization tool not utilized
- Loss of Climate Advisor position

Climate Crisis Response Committee

2025-2026 Recommendations for Continue Progress

1. **Embed Transparency and Engagement Tools**
   - -Climate Policy Public Dashboard re-creation
   - -Climate Awareness Student Survey

2. **Ensure Ownership and Capacity of CCRP Implementation**
   - -Significantly reduced capacity
   - -Strategic and explicit ownership across departments

3. **Improve CCRC's Capacity and Effectiveness**